

Other advice that might smooth the way for this exercise is to remind students right before they start that we aren't interested in what these organizations' websites say about themselves, but what they can learn about them from the rest of the internet. Encourage use of Wikipedia for this type of source research. Encourage them to slow down and to practice "click restraint" once they have Googled one of these orgs. What can they learn from looking at just the search results page, without clicking through to anything? What is the overall impression from a variety of results?

- Center for Consumer Freedom: Many of the Google search results (with or without including the search term funding) indicate this is astroturfing. A look at the Wikipedia page tells us that this org was started by a pretty well known PR guy and the sidebar lists their focus as "represents the interests of restaurant and food companies" and their method as "lobbying."
- National Consumers League: Students may note that it has been around since 1899, has no critical results on the first page of Google results, and even has an entry in the Encyclopedia Britannica.
- One Fair Wage: a legitimately grass-roots effort to raise the minimum wage for restaurant workers.
- Save Our Tips: This is one case where adding the word funding to the search helps a bit. If we do that we find sources indicating that this group is funded in part by the National Restaurant Association and a conservative strategy and consulting group. Not what you would expect for a grassroots effort lead by waitstaff.